RESOLUTION NO. 2026-0723

A RESOLUTION OF THE BOARD OF DIRECTORS OF THE PETROLIA FIRE PROTECTION DISTRICT ORDERING THE SUBMISSION OF A SPECIAL TAX MEASURE TO THE QUALIFIED VOTERS OF THE DISTRICT, REQUESTING CONSOLIDATION WITH THE NOVEMBER 3, 2026 STATEWIDE GENERAL ELECTION, AND REQUESTING ELECTION SERVICES FROM THE HUMBOLDT COUNTY OFFICE OF ELECTIONS

WHEREAS, the Petrolia Fire Protection District ("District") is responsible for providing fire protection, emergency medical response, rescue services, and other essential emergency response services within its jurisdiction for the protection of life, property, and the environment; and

WHEREAS, the District has determined that existing revenue sources are insufficient to sustain an adequate level of fire protection and emergency response services due to increasing service demands, rising operational costs, and the need to maintain firefighter readiness and safety; and

WHEREAS, additional locally controlled funding is necessary to maintain and improve fire protection and emergency response services, including the operation, maintenance, acquisition, replacement, and improvement of firefighting equipment, apparatus, facilities, and other essential capital improvements necessary to protect the public and ensure firefighter safety; and

WHEREAS, California Health and Safety Code Section 13911 authorizes the District to levy a special tax pursuant to Article 3.5 (commencing with Section 50075) of Chapter 1 of Part 1 of Division 1 of Title 5 of the Government Code, upon approval of two-thirds of the votes cast at an election.

WHEREAS, pursuant to the California Elections Code, it is appropriate for the Board to request the consolidation of the District's election with the statewide general election, and to request that the Humboldt County Registrar of Voters provide all necessary election services; and

WHEREAS, pursuant to Section 50077, the District Board provided notice of the public hearing on this matter in the form and manner provided by law; and

WHEREAS, the District Board heard and fully considered all the evidence presented at a public hearing held on July 16, 2026.

NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED by the Board of Directors of the Petrolia Fire Protection District as follows:

1. **Recitals.** The foregoing recitals are true and correct and are hereby incorporated by reference.

2. **Call for Election; Placement of Measure on Ballot.** Pursuant to Government Code Section 50077, the Board hereby calls an election at which it shall submit to the qualified voters of the District a measure authorizing a special tax. This measure shall be designated by letter by the Humboldt County Registrar of Voters.

3. **Election Date.** The election shall be held within the boundaries of the District and consolidated with the Statewide General Election on Tuesday, November 3, 2026, and conducted in accordance with the Election Code.

4. **Ballot Question.** The ballot question to be submitted to the voters shall read substantially as follows:

To provide a stable, locally controlled source of funding to maintain and improve fire protection and emergency response services and to support long-term fire service sustainability in the region, shall Ordinance No. 2026-01 of the Petrolia Fire Protection District establishing an annual special tax of $75 per taxable unimproved parcel, $95 per taxable improved parcel, and $160 per qualifying contiguous parcel group, raising an estimated $21,181 annually unless repealed by the voters, be adopted?	YES	
	NO	

5. **Special Tax Ordinance.** The ordinance authorizing the special tax to be approved by the voters pursuant to this Resolution is as set forth in Exhibit A hereto. The Board of Directors hereby approves the ordinance, and form thereof, and its submission to the voters of the District at the November 3, 2026 election, subject to the approval of two-thirds of the voters voting on the measure at the election called by the adoption of this resolution. The full text of the ordinance shall be included in the voters' pamphlet. The Ordinance establishes the special tax, including the applicable tax rates, authorized exemptions, annual adjustment provisions, and collection procedures.

6. **Publication of Measure.** The District Clerk/Secretary is hereby directed to cause notice of the measure to be published once in the official newspaper of the District, in accordance with Section 12111 of the Elections Code and Section 6061 of the Government Code.

7. **Request for Consolidation, Conduct of Election, and Canvass of Returns.**
   a. Pursuant to Part 3 (commencing with Section 10400) of Division 10 of the Elections Code, the Humboldt County Board of Supervisors is hereby requested to order consolidation of the District Election with the Statewide General Election on Tuesday, November 3, 2026, for the purpose of placing the measure set forth in this Resolution on the ballot.

b. The District acknowledges that the consolidated election will be held and conducted in the manner prescribed in Section 10418 of the Elections Code.

c. The District requests the Humboldt County Registrar of Voters provide all necessary election services and agrees to reimburse the County for actual costs incurred.

8. **Effective Date.** This Resolution shall become effective immediately upon its adoption and the District Clerk/Secretary is directed to send copies of the Resolution to the Humboldt County Board of Supervisors and the Humboldt County Registrar of Voters.

PASSED AND ADOPTED this 16th day of July, 2026.

AYES: THREE
NOES: NONE
ABSTAIN: NONE
ABSENT: NONE

Chair, Board of Directors
Petrolia Fire Protection District

ATTEST:

Clerk/Secretary, Board of Directors
Petrolia Fire Protection District

EXHIBIT A

ORDINANCE NO. 2026-01

AN ORDINANCE OF THE PETROLIA FIRE PROTECTION DISTRICT ESTABLISHING A SPECIAL TAX ON REAL PROPERTY TO SUPPORT AND MAINTAIN QUALITY LOCAL FIRE PROTECTION AND ESSENTIAL EMERGENCY RESPONSE SERVICES

The people of the Petrolia Fire Protection District do ordain as follows:

SECTION 1: Authority. This Ordinance is enacted pursuant to Government Code Section 50075 and Article XIII A of the California Constitution. If approved by at least two-thirds of voters, it will establish a special tax on parcels of real property within the Petrolia Fire Protection District (District) to fund fire protection, rescue, emergency medical, and other essential emergency response services, as described herein.

SECTION 2: Purpose and Intent. The proceeds from this special tax shall be used solely for the purpose of providing ongoing fire protection and emergency response services, including but not limited to fire suppression and prevention; emergency medical and rescue services; hazardous materials response; and the operation, maintenance, and acquisition of firefighting equipment, apparatus, facilities and necessary capital improvements to ensure the safety of the public and firefighting personnel.

The tax is intended to maintain and improve the current level of fire protection and emergency response services, provide long-term fiscal stability, and support capital reserves for essential asset replacement. All expenditures shall be consistent with the Fire Protection District Law of 1987 and the specific needs of the District.

SECTION 3: Definitions.

“Board” means the Board of Directors of the District.

“Contiguous Parcel” means parcels which share a common boundary line of any length that is greater than a single point and share identical ownership.

“CPI” means the Consumer Price Index for All Urban Consumers (CPI-U), All Items, West Region, not seasonally adjusted, as published by the United States Department of Labor, Bureau of Labor Statistics, or any successor index published by the Bureau if this index is discontinued.

“Current Taxes” means the District’s existing fire assessment approved and collected prior to the adoption of this Ordinance.

“Fiscal Year” means the period starting July 1 and ending on the following June 30.

"Improved” means taxable land within the District that contains a structure that the

District determines may require the use of apparatus, equipment, and personnel to suppress a structural fire, such as a home, business, agricultural, or utility building.

“Vacant” means taxable land within the District that does not contain an improved structure.

“Improvement status” means a determination by the District based on the best available information that property is improved or vacant. Best available information shall include, but not be limited to, Use Codes or improvement value as assigned by the Humboldt County Assessor, building permit information referred to the District by the Humboldt County Planning and Building Department, and site information collected by the District. Where the District finds that Use Codes or improvement value as assigned by the Humboldt County Assessor may be in error, the District will work with Humboldt County to promptly correct any errors.

“Taxable Parcels” means those parcels that appear on the annual secured property tax roll and are billable for District services.

SECTION 4: Special Tax Rate. Beginning with the 2027-2028 fiscal year, the special tax shall be levied at flat rates based on the use of each taxable parcel of real property, in accordance with the schedule below.

Parcel Use Category Descriptions:

Taxable Improved Parcels - This land use classification identifies taxable parcels containing one or more improved structures, as defined in Section 3 of this Ordinance. These properties are subject to the Improved Parcel special tax rate established in Section 4 and are deemed to receive benefit from the availability of fire protection, emergency medical response, rescue, and other emergency response services provided by the District.
This classification includes, but is not limited to:

- Single-family residential parcels;
- Mobile or manufactured home parcels;
- Multi-family residential developments;
- Commercial, industrial, agricultural, utility, and other developed properties containing one or more improved structures.

Taxable Unimproved Parcels - This land use classification identifies taxable parcels that do not contain an improved structure, as defined in Section 3 of this Ordinance. These properties are subject to the Unimproved Parcel special tax rate established in Section 4 and are deemed to receive benefit from the availability of fire protection, emergency

medical response, rescue, and other emergency response services provided by the District.
This classification includes, but is not limited to:

- Vacant residential parcels;
- Vacant commercial or industrial parcels;
- Undeveloped agricultural or resource lands;
- Other privately owned parcels legally capable of development under applicable land use regulations.

Contiguous Parcels - Contiguous taxable parcels held under identical ownership, and approved by the District in accordance with this Ordinance, shall be treated as a single taxable parcel and assessed the Contiguous Parcel special tax rate.

Non-Taxable Parcels (Exempt) — This land use classification identifies properties that are exempt from the special tax but shall be reviewed periodically to confirm their exemption status. This classification may include, but is not limited to:

- Government-owned, quasi-government-owned, or other public properties;
- Properties exempt from property taxation pursuant to the California Revenue and Taxation Code or other applicable law;
- Public streets and road rights-of-way that are not assigned an Assessor's Parcel Number;
- Common areas, sliver parcels, bifurcated lots, or other parcels that cannot be independently developed.

Land Use Type	Annual Tax
Taxable Improved Parcels	$95.00
Taxable Unimproved Parcels	$75.00
Contiguous parcels under identical ownership*	$160.00
Non-taxable, or exempt	$0.00

*A single charge of $160.00 will be levied for all contiguous parcels with a qualified exemption.

SECTION 5: Exemption from Special Tax
Assessor’s parcels that are partially or wholly exempt from property tax shall be identified by the Assessor's Office for the District and include public owned parcels (United States of America and State of California, or other local agencies) and other exemptions established by state law. Three additional specific exemptions from the special tax were approved by the District voters on November 3rd, 2026:

A. **Hardship Exemption.** Landowners who fall within the U.S. Department of Housing and Urban Development (HUD) Guidelines for "very low"; or "poverty level" income, may apply to the District Board for a "Hardship Exemption" from the special tax. The owners of such parcels shall submit an application form annually, for each year the exemption is claimed, as established in Attachment A to this Ordinance, to the District Board, providing the owner(s) name and address, number of household members, income verification for the previous year, the most recent property tax bill to demonstrate property ownership, and declaration under penalty of perjury that the applicant(s) qualify for the exemption per HUD Guidelines. Policies and procedures and revisions to the application form that may be necessary to carry out this exemption, shall be approved by Resolution at a public meeting by the District Board.

B. **Contiguous Parcel Exemption.** Assessors Parcels which are contiguous and held under identical ownership (see SECTION 3: Definitions), upon approval of an application of the owners thereof to the District Board, are to be treated as a single parcel and charged the contiguous parcel tax of $160.

   The owners of such Assessors Parcels shall submit to the District Board annually an application form, as established in ATTACHMENT B to this Ordinance, for each year the exemption is claimed, providing the owner(s) name and address, property maps, deed and title information that sufficiently demonstrate that the applicant is the owner of record or trustee of the owner of record with Power of Attorney for the owner of record for all the contiguous property. Policies, procedures and revisions of the application form that may be necessary to carry out this exemption, shall be approved by Resolution at a public meeting by the District Board.

C. Volunteer Firefighter Exemption. Volunteer firefighters who are active members in good standing with the District, upon approval of an application of the owner thereof to the District Board, may be granted an exemption from the special tax for a taxable parcel owned and occupied by the qualifying volunteer firefighter. The owners of such taxable parcel shall submit to the District Board annually an application form, as established in ATTACHMENT C to this Ordinance, for each year the exemption is claimed, providing the owner(s) name and address, verification of active volunteer service signed by either the Fire District Chief.

Policies, procedures, and revisions of the application form that may be necessary to carry out this exemption, shall be approved by Resolution at a public meeting by the District Board.

Section 6: Annual Adjustment. An annual inflationary adjustment may be granted to the Special Tax to account for inflation-related increases in the cost of providing fire protection and emergency services. The adjustment shall be the annual percentage change in the CPI, as defined in Section 3 of this Ordinance, for the twelve (12) month period ending in June of the preceding fiscal year.

The District Board may, at its discretion, adopt a lower adjustment factor or elect to forgo the adjustment in any given year. In applying any adjustment under this Section, the District Board shall make findings that operating costs for the District have increased in the preceding fiscal year(s) and that, without applying the adjustment authorized by the voters, the District would be unable to maintain the same level of service to people and property within its jurisdiction.

SECTION 7. Appeals. Any property owner may appeal any determination by the District concerning the nature of the use of the property or the calculation of the amount of the tax by filing a written appeal with the District. Any such appeal shall be filed by December 1st of the calendar year for which the tax is levied and may only be submitted for the current tax year. The appeal shall include the property owner's contact information and the parcel number or address sufficient to identify the property, along with a statement describing the nature and basis for the appeal and any supporting documentation. The District may develop and update, as needed, a standard appeal form and instructions to implement the appeals process.

The Fire Chief, or the Chief's designee, shall review the appeal and issue a written determination within 30 days. If the property owner disagrees with that determination, they may submit a written request for review by the Board of Directors within 15 days. The Board shall consider the appeal at a noticed public meeting, and its decision shall be final and based on whether the District's classification or calculation is consistent with this Ordinance and supported by substantial evidence. Filing an appeal does not relieve the obligation to pay the tax when due; however, if the appeal is granted, the District shall issue a refund or credit as appropriate.

SECTION 8: Method of Collection. On or about July 1st of each year, but in any event in sufficient time to include the levy of the special tax on the County's secured tax roll, the District shall determine the use category and related tax amount representing each parcel of real property within the District subject to the special tax. Parcels subject to levy shall be determined based upon the records of the Humboldt County Assessor or, in lieu thereof, upon such other reliable public records available to the District.

The District Board shall adopt by resolution the special tax roll specifying the special tax amount for each taxable parcel, pursuant to Sections 4 through 6 above. The resolution shall include at a minimum the authority under which the special tax is imposed, and the

information required by the Humboldt County Auditor-Controller.

An electronic file containing the information from the special tax roll and in the form that is required by the Humboldt County Auditor-Controller, along with a copy of the adopted resolution, shall be delivered to the Humboldt County Auditor-Controller on or before the due date to be included with the County property tax bills.

SECTION 9: Collection. The special tax shall be collected in the same manner and subject to the same penalty as, or with, other taxes fixed and collected by Humboldt County on behalf of the Petrolia Fire Protection District. The County of Humboldt may deduct reasonable expenses incurred for such service before remitting the balance to the District.

SECTION 10: Delinquency. To any amount of the special tax created by this ordinance that becomes delinquent, the Humboldt County Tax Collector shall add a penalty in the amount equal to any penalty owing for delinquencies in the ad valorem property tax. The tax and penalty shall bear interest at the same rate as the rate for unpaid ad valorem property tax until paid.

SECTION 11. Special Fund. All funds collected from the tax imposed by this Ordinance shall be deposited into a separate fund account in accordance with Government Code Section 50075 *et seq.* and shall be expended only for the purposes authorized by this Ordinance.

SECTION 12. Authorization for Appropriations Limit Increase. To the extent that the revenue from the special taxes enacted by this Ordinance are in excess of the appropriations limit for the District, as calculated in accordance with the provisions of Article XIII B of the California Constitution and applicable statutory provisions, the approval of this special tax by the voters shall constitute approval to increase the District's spending limit in an amount equal to the revenue derived from the special tax, for the maximum period of time as allowed by law.

SECTION 13: Annual Report. The District's Fire Chief shall cause to be filed an annual report with the Board at least once a year pursuant to Government Code § 50075.3. The report shall state: (a) the amount of special tax revenues collected and spent by the District in the previous fiscal year, (b) the status of any project or work authorized to be funded by the proceeds of this tax, and (c) the funds carried over from previous years and to be carried over in future years. Such report shall be available for inspection without charge to any property owner in the District. The District's Fire Chief shall annually arrange for an independent audit of the accounting for, and expenditure of, the proceeds of the tax.

The District's Fire Chief shall also report annually within seven (7) months after the close

of each fiscal year regarding the special tax to the State Controllers, as required by Government Code Section 12463.2, including the type and rate of parcel tax imposed; the number of parcels subject to the parcel tax; the number of parcels exempt from the parcel tax; the sunset date of the parcel tax, if any; the amount of revenue received from the parcel tax; and the manner in which the revenue received from the parcel tax is being used.

SECTION 14: Interpretation and Amendment. Interpretations may be made by the Board by Resolution for the purpose of clarifying any vagueness or ambiguity as it relates to the special tax or this Ordinance. The Board may amend this Ordinance at any time; provided, however, that any Ordinance amendment that increases the special tax rate above the rate approved by the voters at the November 3, 2026 election shall become effective only if approved by a two-thirds vote of the District voters voting on the issue.

SECTION 15: Severability. If any provision of this Ordinance or its application to any person or circumstance is held to be invalid, such invalidity has no effect on the other provisions or applications of the Ordinance that can be given effect without the invalid provision or application, and to this extent, the provisions of this resolution are severable. The Board declares that it would have adopted this Ordinance irrespective of the invalidity of any portion thereof. Furthermore, the Board finds and declares that nothing in this Ordinance is intended to effect an increase in the special tax rate or otherwise effect an extension of the special tax beyond what is permitted by the Special Tax Ordinance.

SECTION 16. Validation. Pursuant to the provisions of Government Code Section 50077.5, any judicial action or proceeding to attack, review, set aside, void or annul this Ordinance or the approval of the special tax or increase in the spending limitation pertaining to the special tax shall be commenced, if at all, within 60 days of the date of the effective date of this Ordinance.

SECTION 17: Effective Date. This Ordinance shall be effective only at such time as the District Board has declared that the Ordinance has been approved by two-thirds of the voters voting at an election to be held on November 3, 2026. If this Ordinance is approved, the special tax shall be collected at the rates established by this Ordinance beginning with the 2027-2028 fiscal year until repealed by voters.

SECTION 18. Certification. The District Secretary shall certify to the passage and adoption of this Ordinance and shall cause a copy of the full text of the Ordinance to be posted.

ATTACHMENT A

PETROLIA FIRE PROTECTION DISTRICT

HARDSHIP EXEMPTION REQUEST FORM, POLICY, GUIDELINES & INSTRUCTIONS

POLICY

The Petrolia Fire Protection District ("District") established, by adoption of Ordinance 2026-01, Section 5A, Hardship Exemption to allow landowners who fall within the U.S. Department of Housing and Urban Development (HUD) Guidelines for "very low"; or "poverty level" income, to apply to the District Board for a partial or complete exemption from the tax.

GUIDELINES

In order to be considered for an exemption, property owners are required to submit an annual application to the District Board. Required information on this form include the owner(s) name, mailing address, email address, phone number, the assessor's parcel number, last year's household income and total number of household members and a declaration under penalty of perjury that the applicant(s) qualify for the exemption per HUD Guidelines. Attachments include income verification for the previous year and the most recent property tax bill (to demonstrate property ownership).

The official State Income Limits for all counties are posted at the Department of Housing and Community Development's (Department) website: https://www.hcd.ca.gov/funding/income-limits/state-federal-income-limits/state

INSTRUCTIONS

Filing Deadline:
Your Hardship Exemption Request Form must be submitted to the District by **March 31** each year you wish to be considered for an exemption. Your completed request form can be mailed to the Petrolia Fire Protection District, PO Box 169, Petrolia, CA 95558. Or scan and email to: secretary@petroliafire.org.

PETROLIA FIRE PROTECTION DISTRICT
HARDSHIP EXEMPTION REQUEST FORM
FY 202x-2x

OWNER(s) INFORMATION:

Owner(s) Name:	Date:
Mailing Address:	Phone Number:
Email Address:	Assessor's Parcel Number:

INCOME INFORMATION:

Last Year's Household Income $ _____	Number of Household Members _____
⬜ Current Property Bill Attached	⬜ Previous Tax Form Attached
⬜ Other Proof of Income Attached	

I declare under penalty of perjury that the foregoing is true and correct and that my income meets the "very low" or "poverty level" guidelines. I also understand that this form must be submitted each year the exemption is claimed.

_____ _____

Owner's Signature Date

FOR DISTRICT USE ONLY:

⬜ Attachments Verified: By: _____ Date: _____	
⬜ Request Approved	⬜ Request Denied Date: _____

ATTACHMENT B

PETROLIA FIRE PROTECTION DISTRICT

CONTIGUOUS PARCEL EXEMPTION REQUEST
POLICY, DESCRIPTIONS & INSTRUCTIONS

POLICY The Petrolia Fire Protection District ("District") established, by adoption of Ordinance 2026-01, Section 5B, Contiguous Parcel Exemption for Assessor's parcels which share a common boundary line of any length that is greater than a single point and are held under identical ownership, upon approval of an application of the owners thereof to the District Board, to be treated as a single parcel for purposes of this special tax.

DEFINITIONS For the purpose of this application, the following definitions apply:

Contiguous: Parcels which share a common boundary line of any length that is greater than a single point.

Identical Ownership: The District Board will allow substantial latitude in determining ownership and control of contiguous parcels, as spelled out in said Ordinance 2026-01. In the event that the owner of record of two contiguous parcels is not identical, the applicant must demonstrate to the satisfaction of the District Board that they have a controlling interest in the property(ies) claimed as contiguous. Such property(ies) may include parcels owned by corporations, trusts or estates.

Maps: Suitable maps include Assessor Parcel maps showing all contiguous parcels, which are available at the Humboldt County Assessor's Office (825 5th Street, Room 300, Eureka) or on-line at https://common1.mptsweb.com/mbap/humboldt/asr (enter Assessor's Parcel Number in the "Fee Parcel" search field). Maps containing all contiguous parcels can also be printed from the Humboldt County Planning and Building Web Geographic Information System at https://webgis.co.homboldt.ca.us/HCEGIS2.0/ .

Proof of Title or Deed: Suitable proof of title would include your most recent property tax bill (with Assessor's Parcel Number shown) or the first page of your Deed or Trust document.

INSTRUCTIONS

Filing Deadline: Your Contiguous Parcel Exemption Request Form must be submitted to the District by **No Later Than March 31** of each year you wish to be considered for an exemption, to the Petrolia Fire Protection District, PO Box 169, Petrolia, CA 95558. Or scan and email to: secretary@petroliafire.org.

DRAFT 251110

PETROLIA FIRE PROTECTION DISTRICT
CONTIGUOUS PARCEL(S) EXEMPTION REQUEST FORM
FY 202x-2x

OWNER(s) INFORMATION:

Owner(s) Name:	Date:
Mailing Address:	Phone Number:
Email Address:	⬜ Map(s) Attached ⬜ Proof of Title or Deed Attached

PARCEL INFORMATION:

Assessor's Parcel Number(s) (APNs) To Be Considered For An Exemption	Are You the Owner of This Parcel? (Y/N)	Is There a Structure on This Parcel? (Y/N)	Describe Parcel's Use And/Or Improvements

I declare under penalty of perjury that the foregoing is true and correct. I also understand that this form must be submitted each year the exemption is claimed.

_____ _____

Owner's Signature Date

FOR DISTRICT USE ONLY:

⬜Map/Title Attachments Verified By: _____Date: _____
⬜Exemption Request Approved ⬜Exemption Request Denied Date:_____

ATTACHMENT C

PETROLIA FIRE PROTECTION DISTRICT

VOLUNTEER FIREFIGHTER EXEMPTION REQUEST FORM, POLICY, GUIDELINES & INSTRUCTIONS

POLICY

The Petrolia Fire Protection District ("District") established, by adoption of Ordinance 2026-01, Section 5C, Volunteer Firefighter Exemption to allow landowners who are active volunteer firefighters in good standing with the District, upon approval of an application of the owner thereof to the District Board, may be granted an exemption from the special tax for a taxable parcel owned and occupied by the qualifying volunteer firefighter.

GUIDELINES

In order to be considered for this exemption, volunteer firefighter/property owners are required to submit an annual application to the District Board. Required information on this form include the owner(s) name, mailing address, email address, phone number, the assessor's parcel number, and verification of active volunteer service signed by either the Fire District Chief.

This exemption shall apply to one parcel per qualifying volunteer firefighter and shall only apply to the taxable parcel charge of $95. It shall not apply to any contiguous parcel charge or other special tax rate established by this Ordinance.

INSTRUCTIONS

Filing Deadline:

Your Hardship Exemption Request Form must be submitted to the District by **March 31** each year you wish to be considered for an exemption. Your completed request form can be mailed to the Petrolia Fire Protection District, PO Box 169, Petrolia, CA 95558. Or scan and email to: secretary@petroliafire.org.

DRAFT 251110

PETROLIA FIRE PROTECTION DISTRICT
VOLUNTEER FIREFIGHTER EXEMPTION REQUEST FORM
FY 202x-2x

OWNER/FIREFIGHTER INFORMATION:

Owner(s) Name:	Date:
Mailing Address:	Phone Number:
Email Address:	Assessor's Parcel Number:

I declare under penalty of perjury that the foregoing is true and correct and that I am a Petrolia Fire Protection District volunteer firefighter in good standing. I also understand that this form must be submitted each year the exemption is claimed.

_____ _____

Owner/Firefighter's Signature Date

Fire Chief Verification:

I declare under penalty of perjury that this exemption applicant is a Petrolia Fire Protection District volunteer firefighter in good standing. This means that they follow the policy set forth in the Firefighter Active Volunteer Performance Standards of the Petrolia Fire Protection District.

_____ _____

Fire Chief's Signature Date

FOR DISTRICT USE ONLY:

⬜ Attachments Verified: By: _____ Date: _____
⬜ Request Approved ⬜ Request Denied Date: _____

MEASURE J – IMPARTIAL ANALYSIS

HUMBOLDT COUNTY COUNSEL

PETROLIA FIRE PROTECTION DISTRICT

SPECIAL TAX FOR FIRE PROTECTION AND EMERGENCY MEDICAL SERVICES

Measure J is a special tax ordinance placed on the ballot by the Board of Directors of the Petrolia Fire Protection District. As a "special tax," Measure J must be approved by two-thirds of the voters voting in the election, and the funds raised may only be used for the specified purposes in the ordinance, which are "providing ongoing fire protection and emergency response services, including but not limited to fire suppression and prevention; emergency medical and rescue services; hazardous materials response; and the operation, maintenance, and acquisition of firefighting equipment, apparatus, facilities and necessary capital improvements to ensure the safety of the public and firefighting personnel."

Measure J would create a "parcel tax." This means each taxable parcel is charged a flat rate, depending upon its intensity of use. Parcels with one or more structures which may require fire suppression services, such as a home or business, would be taxed $95 per year. Parcels that have the potential to be developed, but are not, would be taxed $75 per year. Contiguous parcels under identical common ownership, regardless of whether they contain structures, would be taxed $160 dollars per year. This requires an approved application from the property owner. Some properties are exempt from the tax. This includes property owned by government entities, properties exempt from real property taxes under other laws, and parcels which do not have the potential for development.

These taxes may be adjusted for inflation each year based on the percentage change in the Consumer Price Index. The taxes would be placed on the secured tax roll and collected by the Humboldt County Tax Collector in the same manner as other property taxes.

Measure J includes a hardship waiver, which allows a tax exemption for property owners who fall within the U.S. Department of Housing and Urban Development's definitions of "very low" or "extremely low" income. Measure J also allows active volunteer firefighters in good standing with the district to apply for and receive an exemption from the tax. There is an appeal process by which a property owner can

challenge the district's determination of the nature and use of a parcel or the calculation of the tax.

As required by state law, Measure J requires the creation of a special fund into which all proceeds will be deposited, and requires an annual report showing "(a) the amount of special tax revenues collected and spent by the District in the previous fiscal year, (b) the status of any project or work authorized to be funded by the proceeds of this tax, and (c) the funds carried over from previous years and to be carried over in future years."

Argument in Favor of Measure J

Since 1951, Petrolia's volunteer firefighters have answered the call when their neighbors needed help. That commitment has not changed, but the cost and complexity of providing emergency services have.

Basic operational costs—including insurance, fuel, equipment, apparatus replacement, training, and regulatory requirements—continue to climb. We cannot expect volunteer firefighters to carry an ever-growing administrative and financial burden with resources that no longer keep pace with reality.

Measure J provides stable local funding through a flat special tax of $95 annually for improved parcels and $75 for unimproved parcels. To ensure fairness, the measure includes exemptions for qualifying low-income property owners and active volunteer firefighters, as well as a $160 flat rate for qualifying contiguous properties held under identical ownership.

Crucially, Measure J is part of a larger regional solution. Approval provides the local funding needed to continue the proposed reorganization of Petrolia, Honeydew, and Telegraph Ridge fire services into the Mattole Fire Protection District. Additionally, Measure J and reorganization together create the opportunity to secure a Property Tax Exchange Agreement with Humboldt County, bringing additional property tax dollars that residents already pay back to the area to support local fire and emergency services.

Together, these resources will create a more sustainable local fire service, with shared administrative support, reliable engines and equipment, stronger emergency response, and each community retaining its local fire department.

Dependable emergency service requires dependable funding. Measure J supports local control, supports our volunteers, and sustains local fire and emergency services for generations to come.

Please vote YES on Measure J.

BALLOT ARGUMENT STATEMENT FORM

Elections Code Section 9600

All arguments concerning measures filed pursuant to California Elections Code Division 9, commencing with Section 9000, shall be accompanied by the following form statement, to be signed by each proponent and by each author, if different, of the argument:

The undersigned proponent(s) or author(s) of the primary (primary/rebuttal to)

argument in favor (in favor of/against) ballot proposition Measure J (name or number)

at the 2026 November General Election (title of election)

for the Petrolia Fire Protection District (jurisdiction)

to be held on November 3rd, 2026 (date of election) hereby state that such

argument is true and correct to the best of their (his/her/their) knowledge and belief.

Signed _____ Date 8/12/2026

Printed name Sara Hanover Title Petrolia FPD Commissioner

Signed _____ Date 8/12/2026

Printed name Jeff Skehen Title Petrolia FPD Commissioner

Signed _____ Date 8/12/2026

Printed name Chris Gilda Title Petrolia FPD Fire Chief

Signed _____ Date 8/12/2026

Printed name Tanner Speas Title Telegraph Ridge FPD Fire Chi

Signed _____ Date 8/12/2026

Printed name Lars Samuels Title Honeydew VFC Fire Chief

AUTHOR INFORMATION

Signed _____ Date 8/12/2026

Printed name Nathan Queener Title Petrolia FPD Commissioner

Mailing Address PO Box 169 - Petrolia, CA 95558